

Save this

AI x Marketing

ChatGPT text in the EU is getting an invisible watermark.

What it can show, what it can't, and
what I'd change in your workflow.

EU





01 · The news

OpenAI announced it on 5 October.

Over the coming weeks, eligible ChatGPT and Codex text made in the EU gets an invisible watermark. It's OpenAI's answer to the [EU AI Act](#), which wants AI text to be machine-detectable.



02 · How it works

It hides in word choice, not on screen.

The method, called textGrain, nudges which words the model picks. A detector looks for that statistical pattern. Your text looks exactly the same.



03 · How reliable

~80%
of 200-token passages detected.

About 95% at 400 tokens, at a 1% false-positive target, for prose like psychology. Much lower for maths-like text, and editing weakens it. OpenAI says so itself.

Source: OpenAI, 5 Oct 2026



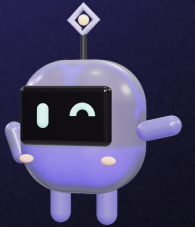
What a watermark **can't** tell anyone

CAN'T TELL

- ◆ Who wrote or prompted it
- ◆ How much a human changed
- ◆ Whether it's true
- ◆ That no watermark means a human wrote it

CAN SIGNAL

- ◆ That an OpenAI model made or processed part of it
- ◆ Only if the passage is long enough



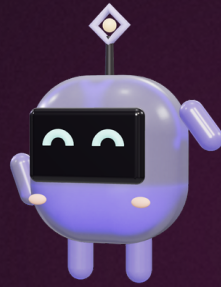
05 · Who can check

Not your client. Not yet.

The detector isn't public. At launch, only approved researchers and expert organisations can apply. In the API, watermarking is opt-in and **off by default**.

What I'd do this week

- 01 Edit AI drafts for quality and facts, not to hide AI use.
- 02 Check client and creator contracts for AI-disclosure clauses.
- 03 Decide your own disclosure rule before a client asks.
- 04 Ignore 'AI detector' screenshots. They prove very little.



Save this

Free guide inside

Save this before your next client call.

Full breakdown, sources and a
disclosure template on Build with Vish.

YOUR TURN

Would you tell a client a draft was AI-assisted? Yes or no?

Save · Follow for AI x marketing